NINAIVU KALANJIYAM · EN EDITION

Rajeshwari's Life Biography — NinaivuKalanjiyam

Narrator: Rajeshwari (பாடகி) · Birth: 1948 · 📍 Erode

📖 Life Story Chapters

Early Years in Bavanipur

Her childhood began in Purushamalai before her family relocated to Bavanipur, where she spent her early years on Pazhanipuram Gounder Street, residing in the third street within a thatched house. The home was situated beside a flowing river on both sides, allowing her to assist her mother with daily chores. She would walk to school, return home for her midday meal prepared by her mother, and head back at 1:45 PM. During these formative years, she and her younger sister rarely left the premises, dedicating their time instead to helping their parents at home.

Education and the Path to Teaching

She completed her first through fifth grades at the CSI school, followed by her studies at the Boys and Girls High School, where she experienced co-education. Immediately after finishing the eleventh grade, she enrolled in a two-year Teacher Training program at GDS in Erode. Her professional journey commenced in 1972. Her initial teaching post was at the Dip City Palayam Union in Bavanipur. She later worked in Kavunthapadi for about seven years. After failing to secure a position back in Bavanipur, she returned to Dip City Palayam, where she remained for thirty-two years.

Family Bonds and Upbringing

Her parents held a deep affection for her and her siblings, rarely sending them to others' houses and personally fulfilling all their needs. Even when they stepped out, they ensured they returned by evening. She grew up with two older brothers. The elder brother worked as a secretary at the Land Mortgage Bank, while the younger brother was a high school clerk. She shared a close bond with her younger sister, with whom she walked to and from school together. However, due to a lack of space to study, her sister could not continue her education and eventually settled in Salem. The siblings consistently supported their parents at home.

Daily Life and Childhood Pastimes

Traveling to school was done entirely on foot. Upon returning home for lunch, she and her sister would fetch water from the well to help their mother before sitting down to study. Lacking electricity at home, their studies were illuminated by kerosene lamps. Traditional outdoor games were not a part of their daily routine. They stayed within the household to assist their parents, only venturing out to play the game of 'Thayakkam' during the May school holidays.

Memories of Teachers and Friends

She recalled all her elementary teachers as good instructors, holding a distinct memory of a fourth-grade teacher named Gnanasundaram. He had reprimanded her severely—striking her on the forehead with a square stick—when she missed school for her elder brother's wedding, questioning if she too was getting married. Later, the teachers at the Girls High School treated her well. Among her childhood friends, she remembered Subhadra Teacher and Sarojini Teacher, both of whom have since passed away; Sarojini Teacher's daughter, Uma, is now the headmaster at their alma mater. She also maintained ties with Rukmani, a friend from Kaligarayampalayam who completed Teacher Training, worked as a teacher in Coimbatore, and has since retired. Rukmani later married a man named Easwari, who resides in Kaligarayampalayam, a village located near Bavanipur.

⏳ Life Timeline Milestones

1972 **First Teaching Job** 📍 Erode

In the year 1972, I joined the teaching profession for the first time in the Tip City Palayam.

1972 **Migration from Purushamala to Bhavani** 📍 Erode

Rajeshwari migrated from Purushamala to Bhavani during her childhood.

1972 **School Education** 📍 Erode

Studied from first to fifth grade at CSI School, and later attended Boys High School and Girls High School.

1972 **Beginning of Teaching Career** 📍 Erode

Began her teaching career in 1972.

1972 **First Posting in Thippa City Palayam** 📍 Erode

Worked as a teacher for the first time in Thippa City Palayam.

1972 **Work in Kavunthapadi** 📍 Erode

Worked as a teacher in Kavunthapadi for seven years.

1972 **Attempt for Bhavani Posting** 📍 Erode

Attempted to get a posting in Bhavani but did not receive it, returning to Thippa City Palayam.

1972 **Long-term Service in Thippa City Palayam** 📍 Erode

Served as a teacher in Thippa City Palayam for thirty-two years.

Migration from Purushamalam to Bhavani 📍 Erode

During her childhood, the family moved from Purushamali to Bhavani.

Education at CSI School 📍 Erode

CSI studied from first to fifth standard in school.

Secondary School Education 📍 Erode

Boys studied together with the girls at the High School and the High School for Girls.

Teacher Training 📍 Erode

After completing her 11th standard, she underwent two years of teacher training at GDS in Erode.

Work in Kaunthapadi 📍 Erode

Unsuccessful in her attempts to get Bhavani, she worked for about seven years in Gowndapadi.

Long-term Service in Thippa City Palayam 📍 Erode

After Goundapadi, he returned to Dibb City Palayam and worked there for 32 years.

Home in Bhavani and School Journey 📍 Erode

Bhavani lived in a house on Gounder Street in Palani Pazhanipuram, and walked to school and returned home for lunch.

Helping Mother with Household Chores 📍 Erode

She went to school after helping her mother with all the housework.

Helping with Household Chores Erode

As a child, she stayed home without leaving the house to help her mother and to help her father; she also did housework along with her sister.

Playing Thayyakar during May Holidays Erode

The traditional sport of Thaayakkar was played only during the month of May.

Parents' Love and Care Erode

Mothers and fathers did not send them away alone, but always stayed close by, giving them their needs.

Siblings' Education and Employment Erode

Both the brothers worked in a bank and a high school, while her sister lives in Salem.

Going to School Together and Younger Sister's Education Erode

The speaker also mentions that their sister went to school together with them, but their sister didn't continue her studies and went to work.

Walking to School and Studying by a Cement Lamp Erode

Walking to school, returning home for lunch, and then going back to school until evening, and studying under a candle lamp because there was no electricity at home.

Fetching Water from the Well Erode

After finishing school and returning home, since mother needed water, she went to the well, fetched water, brought it, and poured it.

Teacher's Strictness at CSI School Erode

The incident of Gnanasundaram, the fourth-grade teacher, hitting his head with a stick because he couldn't take leave for his brother's wedding.

Elementary Education at CSI School 📍 Erode

Experience of studying in CSI school up to fifth standard.

Good Conduct of High School Teachers 📍 Erode

The teachers in high school (high school) were very good.

School Friends 📍 Erode

The death of Palikar's friends Subhadra and Sarojini teachers and the present condition of their children.

Rukmani's Life 📍 Erode

Rukmani Kalingarayampalayam, a friend of Palikar, completed her teacher training and retired after working as a teacher in Coimbatore.

Eswari's Marriage 📍 Erode

Eshwari, a woman married to Kalingarayampalayam, lives near Bhavani.

Growing up in the house and by the river in Bhavani 📍 Erode

Recalling living in a thatched house on the third street in Palanipuram Gounder Street, Bhavani, and the memories associated with the river beside the house.

Walking to school and the afternoon meal routine 📍 Erode

Helping their mother with household chores before walking to school, eating the lunch prepared at home, and returning to school at 1:45 PM.

Playing Thayam (Traditional Game) 📍 Erode

The habit of playing the traditional game Thayam, which was only played during the May school holidays.

Parents' Affection and Protection 📍 Erode

Her parents showed great affection and did not send her anywhere or to anyone else's house, fulfilling all her needs themselves.

Closeness with Father 📍 Erode

Her father had a lot of affection for her.

Daily Return of Parents 📍 Erode

Wherever they went, her parents would leave in the morning and return by the evening.

Relationship with Brothers 📍 Erode

Rajeshwari mentions that she had two elder brothers who completed their studies and were employed.

Brothers' Occupations 📍 Erode

One brother worked as a secretary in a land mortgage bank and the other as a clerk in a high school.

School Journey with Younger Sister 📍 Erode

Rajeshwari and her younger sister went to school together and returned home together.

Younger Sister's Education and Residence 📍 Erode

Because Rajeshwari got to study, her younger sister did not get the opportunity to study or go to work, and currently resides in Salem.

School Journey and Daily Routine 📍 Erode

Walking to school, returning home for lunch, going back to school in the afternoon, and returning home in the evening.

Helping Mother 📍 Erode

Fetching water from the well and pouring it for their mother.

Studying by Cement Lamp 📍 Erode

Studying using a cement lamp at home due to the lack of electricity.

Teacher's Strictness During Brother's Wedding 📍 Erode

Fourth-grade teacher Gnanasundaram took issue with the student taking leave for her brother's wedding. When she explained she couldn't attend because of the wedding, he struck her on the head with a stick.

Schooling and Teachers' Impact 📍 Erode

Studied up to fifth grade at a CSI elementary school where all teachers taught well. In high school, the teachers behaved very well.

Childhood Friends 📍 Erode

Recalls childhood friends Subathra Teacher and Sarojini Teacher who have passed away. Also mentions a friend named Rukmani from Kalangrayampalayam.

Rukmani's Life and Marriage 📍 Erode

The friend Rukmani completed teacher training, worked as a teacher in Coimbatore, and retired. She later married a woman named Eswari in Kalangrayampalayam and settled there.

Ninaivu Kalanjiyam · Preservation of Family Oral Histories

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